

grocery store who pulls out a crumpled coupon from her pocket, or are you going to carry two large binders full of neatly organized coupons everywhere you go? There are lots of in-between choices. I started out with two long white envelopes rubberbanded together: one for food coupons and another for the non-food. Women can stick these in their purse and men can keep the envelopes in the glove box of their vehicle. Most discount stores carry the small accordion-file style of coupon wallets for around a dollar. As you gather more coupons you might want a shoebox sized plastic bin with a lid. There are coupon organizers available online that do the majority of the organizing for you: plastic boxes with dividers already built in, some that fit in the baby seat of the shopping cart, and others that attach to the handle in some way. Do a search on eBay for coupon organizer and you will see just how many different organizers there are. Which one should you choose?

In choosing an organizer, keep in mind your lifestyle and motivation behind choosing this hobby. Are you disorganized in every other area of your life? Then you might not want large coupon keepers that require a lot of upkeep in organization. Do you have small children that will be in the child seat of the grocery cart? Your choice might be something you can hold onto, like a coupon wallet, instead of something that takes up a great deal of space in the cart. You can always upgrade as you get the hang of the coupon hobby. Start with something small and work your way up to a larger filing system. Make your choice work for you, and not the other way around. I used a coupon wallet in my first year or two of couponing, but quickly outgrew it and picked up a plastic check file box with a hinged lid, at a garage sale. I labeled the dividers by category. This worked perfectly fine